

LANTANA

Needs full sunlight and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Tip-prune young plants to promote a bushy habit and more flowering stems. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Red spider mite and whitefly may be troublesome. ☉ All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested, and contact with foliage may irritate skin. **L. camara.** Evergreen, rounded to spreading shrub. H and S 3–6ft (1–2m). Bears ovate, finely wrinkled, deep green leaves. From spring to fall, tiny, tubular, 5-lobed flowers, in dense, domed heads, open yellow, then turn red. Many color forms have been selected. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/ 10°C). ‘**Baluclush**’ see *L.c.* Lucky Series LUCKY HONEY BLUSH. **Lucky Series LUCKY HONEY BLUSH (‘Baluclush’)** illus. p.301. **L. delicatissima.** See *L. montevidensis*. **L. montevidensis,** syn. *L. delicatissima, L. sellowiana,* illus. p.310. **L. ‘Radiation’** illus. p.324. **L. sellowiana.** See *L. montevidensis*. **L. ‘Spreading Sunset’** illus. p.324.

LAPAGERIA

PHILESIACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climber, grown for its large, waxy blooms. Frost hardy to half hardy. Requires humus-rich, well-drained soil and partial shade. Water moderately, scarcely at all when not in full growth. Provide support. Thin out congested growth in spring. Propagate in spring by seed, soaked for 2 days before sowing, or in spring or fall by layering. **L. rosea** (Chilean bellflower, Copihue) illus. p.202. **var. albiflora** is an evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climber. H to 15ft (5m). Has oblong to ovate, leathery, dark green leaves. From summer to late fall, produces pendent, fleshy, narrowly bell-shaped, white flowers. Z9–11

Lapeirousia cruenta.
See *Freesia laxa*.
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LARDIZABALA

LARDIZABALACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their foliage and striking flowers. Male and female flowers are produced on the same plant in late fall to winter. Useful for growing on trellises or pergolas. Frost hardy. Grow in any well-drained soil and in a position in sun or partial shade. Propagate by seed in spring, or by stem cuttings in late summer or fall. **L. biternata.** See *L. funaria*. **L. funaria,** syn *L. biternata.* Evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climber. H 10–12ft (3–4m). Rounded leaves have broadly ovate, leathery, dark green leaflets. In winter, produces brown flowers with tiny, whitish petals, the males in drooping spikes, the females solitary. In winter–spring, bears many-seeded, berrylike, purple fruits, 2–3in (5–8cm) long. Z9–11

LARIX

PINACEAE

See also CONIFERS.
L. decidua, syn. *L. europaea* (European larch), illus. p.97.
L. europaea. See *L. decidua*.
L. kaempferi, syn. *L. leptolepis* (Japanese larch). Fast-growing, deciduous, columnar conifer with a conical tip. H 80–100ft (25–30m), S 12–20ft (4–6m). Shoots are purplish-red and leaves are needlelike, flattened, grayish-green or bluish. Small cones have reflexed scales. Z4–9
L. leptolepis. See *L. kaempferi*.

LATHRAEA

OROBANCHACEAE

Genus of spreading perennials that grow as parasites on the roots of trees, in the case of *L. clandestina* on willow or poplar. True leaves are not produced. Fully hardy. Grows in dappled shade cast by host tree and prefers moist conditions. Roots resent being disturbed. Propagate by seed when fresh, in late summer. **L. clandestina** (Toothwort) illus. p.260.

LATHYRUS

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of annuals and perennials, many of them tendril climbers, grown for their racemes of attractive flowers. Flowers are followed by long, thin seed pods. Fully to half hardy. Grow in humus-rich, fertile, well-drained soil and in full light. Provide support and remove dead flowers regularly. Cut down perennials in late fall. Propagate annuals by seed (soaked before sowing) in early spring or early fall, perennials by seed in fall, or by division in spring. Botrytis and mildew may cause problems. ☉ Seeds may cause mild stomach upset if ingested. **L. grandiflorus** (Everlasting pea). Herbaceous, tendril climber, spreading by suckers. H to 5ft (1.5m). Mid-green leaves usually consist of a pair of leaflets. Has unwinged stems and bears neat racemes of pink-purple and red flowers in summer. Z5–8
L. latifolius (Everlasting pea) illus. p.201. ‘**Albus**’ is a herbaceous, tendril climber with winged stems. H 6ft (2m) or more. Leaves have broad stipules and a pair of leaflets. Bears small racemes of white flowers in summer and early fall. ‘**Rosa Perle**’ has rose-pink flowers. Z5–9
L. magellanicus of gardens. See *L. nervosus*. **L. nervosus,** syn. *L. magellanicus* of gardens (Lord Anson’s blue pea). Herbaceous, tendril climber. H to 15ft (5m). Veined, leathery, gray-green leaves each have a pair of leaflets, a 3-branched tendril, and large stipules. Fragrant, purplish-blue flowers are borne in long-stalked racemes in summer. Z9–11
L. odoratus (Sweet pea). Moderately fast-growing, annual, tendril climber. H to 6ft (2m). Has ovate, mid- to dark green leaves with tendrils. Bears fragrant flowers with wine-red standard petals and purple wings and keels, from summer to early fall.Many cultivars have been developed, including dwarf, non-climbing forms. Z9–11

‘**Bristol**’ has long, firm stems bearing racemes of fragrant, pale violet-blue flowers. ‘**Charlie’s Angel**’ is free-flowering, producing racemes of usually 4, highly scented, waved, clear silvery blue flowers that age to lavender-blue. ‘**Cupid Pink**’ illus. p.301. ‘**Gwendoline**’ has strong stems that bear racemes of 4 fragrant, waved, white flowers, heavily suffused with lilac-pink; good for cutting and exhibiting. ‘**High Scent**’ bears racemes of up to 5 or more fragrant, creamy-white flowers, edged with pale blue. ‘**Jilly**’ produces racemes of 4 waved, lightly scented, creamy-white flowers. ‘**Just Julia**’ bears racemes of large, fragrant, lightly ruffled, mid-blue flowers with a paler keel. ‘**Matucana**’ is bushy and bears racemes of 4 fragrant, magenta-purple flowers. ‘**Mrs. Bernard Jones**’ illus. p.201. **L. rotundifolius** (Persian everlasting pea). Herbaceous, tendril climber with winged stems. H to 3ft (1m). Leaves each have narrow stipules, a pair of leaflets, and a 3-branched tendril. Bears small racemes of 3–8 dark purplish pink to brownish red flowers in summer. Z5–9
L. sylvestris (Everlasting pea, Perennial pea). Herbaceous, tendril climber with winged stems. H to 6ft (2m). Leaves each have narrow stipules, a pair of leaflets, and a terminal, branched tendril. In summer and early fall, bears racemes of 4–10 rose-pink flowers, marked with green and purple. Z5–9
L. vernus, syn. *Orobus vernus,* illus. p.260. ‘**Alboreus**’ is a clump-forming perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). In spring, slender stems each bear 3–5 white-and-deep-pink flowers. Has fernlike, much-divided, soft leaves. Z5–9

LAURELIA

ATHEROSPERMATACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their aromatic foliage. Fully to frost hardy; needs shelter from cold winds. Requires sun or partial shade; grows in any but very dry soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. **L. sempervirens,** syn. *L. serrata* of gardens (Chilean laurel). Evergreen, broadly conical tree or shrub. H 50ft (15m), S 30ft (10m). Ovate, leathery leaves are glossy, dark green and very aromatic. Produces small, inconspicuous flowers in summer. Z9–11
L. serrata of gardens. See *L. sempervirens*.

LAURUS

Bay tree, Laurel

LAURACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees, grown for their foliage. Frost hardy, but foliage may be scorched by extremely cold weather or strong, cold winds. Needs a sheltered position in sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. In tubs may be grown well as standards, which should be trimmed during summer. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall. **L. nobilis** (Bay laurel, Sweet bay) illus. p.80. **f. angustifolia** (Willow leaf bay) is an evergreen large shrub or small conical

tree. H to 40ft (12m), S 30ft (10m). Slightly harder than the species with aromatic, leathery, narrow, lance-shaped pale green leaves. Bears small, star-shaped, pale yellowish-green flowers in spring. ‘**Aurea**’ has golden yellow foliage. Z8–11

LAVANDULA

Lavender

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of evergreen, mainly summer-flowering shrubs and subshrubs, with entire or divided, often gray-green leaves, grown for their aromatic foliage and flowers. Can be used as a low hedge. Fully to half hardy. Needs full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Trim hedges lightly in spring to maintain a compact habit. New growth is rarely produced from old wood. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. See also feature panel p.158. **L. angustifolia** (Lavender). Evergreen, bushy shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 4ft (1.2m). Has linear to narrowly ovate, aromatic, gray-felted leaves. In midsummer, produces small, fragrant, tubular, pale to deep purple flowers in dense spikes to 3in (8cm) long. Z5. ‘**Hidcote**’ (syn. *L. ‘Hidcote’*; illus. p.158), H 2ft (60cm), S 2½ft (75cm), is more compact, with dense spikes of fragrant, deep purple flowers and silver-gray leaves. ‘**Folgate**’, H 2½ft (75cm), S 2½-3ft (75–90cm), is early flowering, with very bright violet-blue flowers; good for cutting. ‘**Imperial Gem**’ (illus. p.158), H and S 2ft (60cm), is compact, with narrowly oblong, silvery-gray leaves, and dense spikes of deep purple flowers. **LITTLE LADY (‘Batlad’)**, H and S 16in (40cm), is compact and prolific, with light blue flowers; suitable for hedging. **LITTLE LOTTIE (‘Clarmo’)** (illus. p.158), H and S 1ft (30cm), is dwarf, with bright gray-green leaves and short spikes of pale pink flowers. ‘**Loddon Blue**’ (illus. p.158), H and S 20in (50cm), is compact with deep blue-purple flowers. ‘**Loddon Pink**’, H 1½ft (45cm), S 2ft (60cm), is more compact in habit, with pale pink flowers. ‘**Miss Katherine**’ (illus. p.158), H 2½ft (75cm), S 2ft (60cm), has light pink flowers with silver-green calyces. ‘**Munstead**’, H 1½ft (45cm), S 2ft (60cm), bears purple-blue flowers ‘**Nana Alba**’, H and S 1ft (30cm), is very compact, with white flowers. ‘**Wendy Carlike**’ (illus. p.158), H to 1ft (30cm), is similar to ‘Nana Alba’, but with a more erect, uniform habit. **L. x chaytoriae ‘Richard Gray’.** Evergreen, bushy, compact shrub. H 20in (50cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has linear, aromatic, silvery-gray leaves. Long, unbranched stalks bear vivid, violet-purple flowers in dense spikes, to 3–4in (8–10cm) long, in summer. Z8–11. ‘**Sawyers**’ illus. p.157. **L. dentata.** Evergreen, bushy shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 5ft (1.5m). Aromatic leaves are fernlike, toothed and gray-green. Unbranched stalks bear dense spikes, to 2in (5cm) long, of slightly fragrant, purple-blue flowers, tipped with purpled bracts, in mid- to late summer. Z9–11
L. ‘Fathead’ (illus. p.158). Evergreen, vigorous, rounded, bushy shrub. H and S 16in (40cm). Has linear, aromatic, gray-green leaves. In late spring and summer,